

HTML - The Basics

What is it?

HTML stands for HyperText Markup Language. It's not really a programming language - think of it more like the skeleton of a webpage.

Why does it matter?

Every single website you've ever visited is built on HTML. It's the starting point for web development. Once you know HTML, you can style things with CSS and make them interactive with JavaScript.

The main things to know

- Most tags come in pairs: an opening tag and a closing tag, like `<p>this</p>`
 - A few tags stand alone, like `<img>` or `<br>` - they don't need a closing tag
 - Tags can have extra info attached called attributes, like href in a link
 - Every page has two main parts:
 - head -> the "behind the scenes" stuff (page title, links to CSS, etc.)
 - body -> everything people actually see on the page
-

Tags you'll use all the time

- `<html>` the whole page lives inside this
- `<head>` page info that isn't shown directly
- `<title>` shows up in the browser tab
- `<body>` everything visible goes here
- `<h1>` - `<h6>` headings, h1 is the biggest, h6 the smallest
- `<p>` a paragraph of text
- `<a>` a clickable link
- `<img>` an image

`<div>` a box used to group and organize content

`<span>` like div, but for small bits of text inline

`<ul>/<ol> / <li>` a list and its items

`<table>` for building tables

`<form>` for collecting input from users

`<input>` a field where users type stuff

`<button>` a clickable button

`<br>` just breaks the line